association with SSNCo continued till the end though he claimed, for whatever reason, that he had left by the end of 1909.[24]

After this coup, the moderate directors heaved a sigh of relief that 'this man's absolute powers began to vanish slowly'.[25] But they would not rest until VOC was fully out of the picture.

Shortly after, in September, during Pandithurai Thevar's visit to Tuticorin, the directors met privately to discuss 'the possibility of getting rid of Chidambaram Pillai' altogether. Their main concern was that his central role in the company kept away some prime investors, especially one Abdul Qadir Marakayar, a Tuticorin merchant.[26]

VOC was not unaware of these intrigues. In his autobiography, VOC states with pain that, as the company made steady progress, those who had earlier discouraged him, now went to the extent of conspiring with BI from at least the latter part of 1907 if not earlier.[27] Since BI's attempts to corrupt him with money had failed, he alleged that some of them did not even hesitate to collude with the rival company.[28] Again, in his application for transfer of the security cases against him, in March 1908, VOC alleged that European merchants were using every trick in the book to have him removed from the scene. In this, they had the support of the local government, and they worked in tandem with the moderate directors. At their instance, he said, Waller had tried to influence Pandithurai Thevar to remove him from the company. Similar pressure had been put on S.T.A. Arumugam Pillai, through the Tuticorin Agent of the Bank of Madras. On both occasions, he said, they failed.[29] Where the European merchants and their pliant government backers failed, the moderate and supine directors succeeded to a certain extent.

The efforts to undermine VOC continued. Possibly as a result of this, in November 1907, S. Somasundara Bharati resigned from his position as manager/agent. (But this did not stop him from continuing his Swadeshi work along with VOC.) The same police report stated that VOC was appointed as 'a paid secretary'—as distinct from the statutory position of a company secretary—on a salary of Rs 150 per month.[30] This report is